Zave: Product specification

MVP working slice · Dubai, UAE · 29 October 2026

Product intent

Help Dubai cardholders find issuer offers they can plausibly use, understand the conditions, and compare estimated value without browsing multiple bank sites.

Target user

A Dubai resident or visitor who holds one or more bank cards, shops or dines locally, and wants to find a relevant offer without manually checking every issuer's promotions page.

User need

> When I am choosing where to shop or eat, show me current offers that fit the card I have, explain the likely value and conditions, and let me verify the offer with the issuer.

MVP scope

Included in the working slice

- Citi UAE and HSBC UAE offer-list parsing.
- Shared offer model with benefit, eligibility, validity, channel, source, and confidence fields.
- SQLite persistence, merchant aliases, FTS5 search, review queue, and withdrawal after repeated source misses.
- Search by text; filter by category and card product/issuer.
- Typical-basket input and estimated AED-value ranking.
- Offer source links, expiry cues, and caveats.
- Offline fixture mode so the browser prototype can be demonstrated without a live bank site.
- CLI for collect, normalize, search, report, evaluation, and demo operations.

Explicitly not included

- A verified real-time feed, broad bank coverage, or production hosting.
- User accounts, card-number collection, payments, or personal financial advice.
- Confirmed eligibility for every HSBC list-page offer without detail-page collection.
- Arabic-language offers, PDF terms extraction, or full pagination.
- Automated LLM extraction by default; the optional Groq path requires an API key.
- Affiliate attribution, redemption, or bank integrations.

Main flow

1. User opens the offers page.
2. User searches for a merchant or chooses a category.
3. User optionally selects one or more card products.

4. User optionally enters a typical basket amount in AED.
5. Zave filters ineligible/expired records and ranks the remainder by an illustrative value score.
6. User reviews expiry and caveats, then opens the issuer page to confirm terms.

Functional requirements and acceptance criteria

ID	Requirement	Acceptance
FR-1	Parse issuer pages into a shared offer model	Citi and HSBC fixture blocks normalize into validated records; invalid fields do not silently become trusted offers.
FR-2	Search offers	A text query returns matching active offers; blank search can browse available active offers.
FR-3	Respect wallet selection	With a selected card, results exclude offers belonging to a different issuer or incompatible product where eligibility is known. Uncertain eligibility is disclosed.
FR-4	Apply expiry and lifecycle	Expired/withdrawn offers do not appear; an offer missing twice is withdrawn.
FR-5	Estimate value	Basket-based estimate reflects percent/fixed/cashback/cap/minimum spend and the documented heuristic assumptions.
FR-6	Communicate uncertainty	UI surfaces issuer, source link, expiry, missing eligibility, and caveats; user is told to confirm terms.
FR-7	Work offline for a demo	An empty local database loads fixture offers, but existing records are not overwritten.
FR-8	Reject invalid basket values	API accepts AED 10–50,000 only and returns a clear validation error outside that range.

Product principles

- **Source-first:** every offer points back to its issuer page.
- **No false precision:** values are estimates, and uncertain extraction/eligibility remains visible.
- **Wallet filtering, not card storage:** the prototype needs only product IDs for filtering, never a card number.
- **Graceful offline demo:** use clearly labeled fixtures rather than failing or claiming live coverage.
- **Quality before breadth:** add sources only when policy, freshness, and extraction quality can be checked.

Success measures for a next validation phase

These are proposed targets, not measured outcomes:

- At least 95% exact accuracy on benefit type and expiry, and 90% on value/cap/minimum spend, on a blind source-stratified set before labeling offers verified.
- At least 90% of a small usability-test cohort can find a relevant offer and identify its eligibility in under one minute.
- No expired or withdrawn offer appears in the active result set under tested boundary conditions.
- Every surfaced offer has a source URL; uncertain terms are visibly marked.

Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Issuer page layout changes or blocks collection	Check block counts, alert on sharp drops, retain snapshots, and review before trusting new data.
Offer terms are stale or parsed incorrectly	Display last-verified context where available, expiry, confidence/review state, and issuer source. Build blind evaluation before production.
Card eligibility is ambiguous	Preserve unknown status; avoid claiming a match and direct user to the T&Cs.
Value estimates create false expectations	Label estimates illustrative; keep assumptions explicit and link to source terms.
Source policies restrict automated collection	Review robots and terms before live operation; use conservative request pacing and no login.
Public demo exposes an unfinished service	Keep the current app local until deployment, privacy, security, and monitoring requirements are defined.

Current status

The functional slice is implemented and its offline test suite passes (**12 tests**). It is not live-validated; the fixtures reconstruct rendered text and do not prove the production DOM. The app is available at `http://127.0.0.1:8000` only on the developer's machine. A public deployment and public repository link remain to be configured.